



MUSKETS (1770–1830)

In the later years of the 18th century, greater uniformity in shape, size, and bore diameter of muskets had evolved following the introduction of standard patterns of military musket. Most European countries adopted a robust and often handsome form of this weapon that formed the principal firearm for infantry. Some countries, such as Britain, favored a form of construction in which the barrel was held in place on the stock of the gun by iron pins, but many preferred the use of barrel bands, which made removal and reinstallation of the barrel much easier.

► AMERICAN MUSKET

Date	1770
Origin	US
Barrel	45in (114.3cm)
Caliber	.80in (20.3mm)

While the rifle is often seen as the archetypal American firearm of the American Revolutionary War (1775–83), many smoothbore muskets were used by American troops. Many of these, such as this one, resembled those used by British forces.



Trigger



Frizzen

Frizzen spring

Barrel-retaining pin holds barrel in place



Wooden butt

Cock

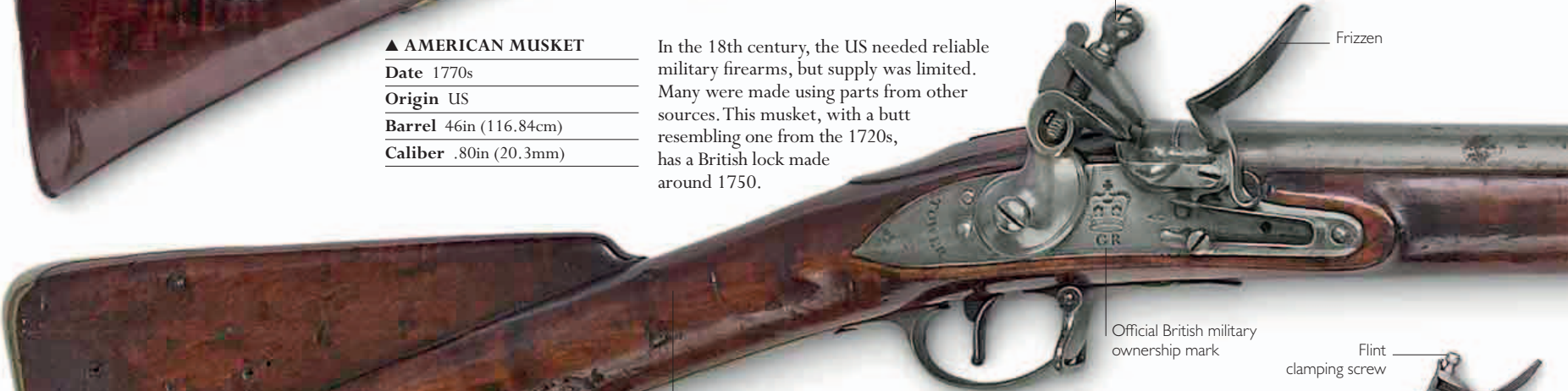
Frizzen

Trigger guard

▲ AMERICAN MUSKET

Date	1770s
Origin	US
Barrel	46in (116.84cm)
Caliber	.80in (20.3mm)

In the 18th century, the US needed reliable military firearms, but supply was limited. Many were made using parts from other sources. This musket, with a butt resembling one from the 1720s, has a British lock made around 1750.



Flint clamping screw

Frizzen

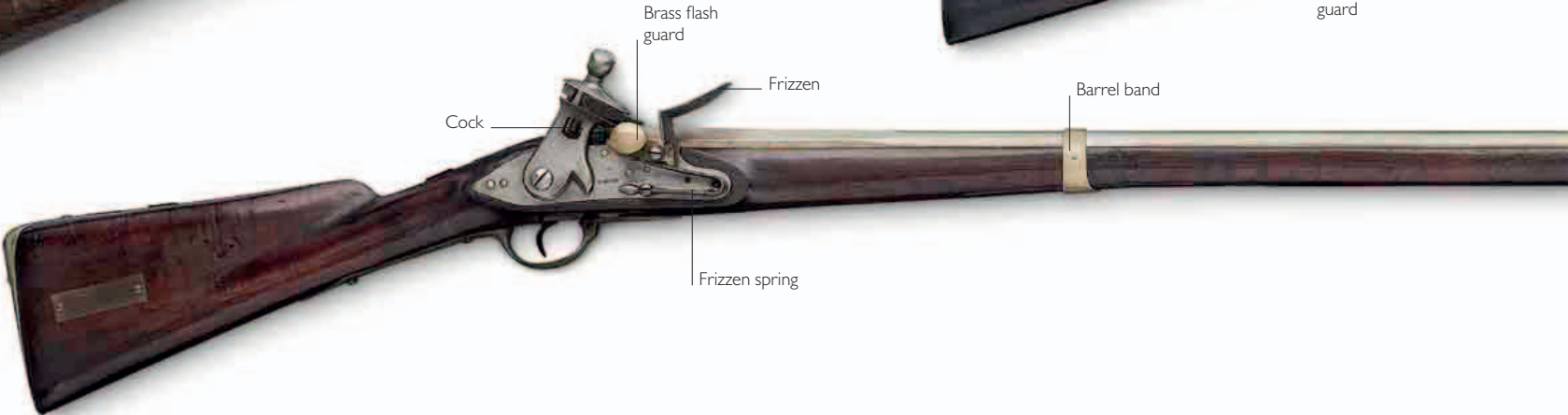
Official British military ownership mark

Flint clamping screw



Small of stock is gripped in hand

Trigger guard



Brass flash guard

Frizzen

Barrel band

Cock

Frizzen spring